

Subject Description Form

Subject Code	ITC5879
Subject Title	Overseas Seminars (Paris)
Credit Value	3
Level	5
Pre-requisite / Co-requisite/ Exclusion	Nil
Objectives	The goals of this course will enable students to: 1. understand the influences of luxury industries on fashion and fashion marketing in each of the participating countries of the program and to highlight the forces that are currently at play; 2. familiarize themselves with the consumer demographics and the psychographics of the dominant luxury markets in France; 3. recognize the importance of the history of the retail establishments in France and their effect on retail practices worldwide, and 4. evaluate various types of production facilities with particular emphasis on the production of luxury goods.
Intended Learning Outcomes	Upon completion of the subject, students will be able to: 1. Appreciate the socio-cultural orientations in global fashion market. 2. Manage and understand the cultural differences and similarities in an era of globalization. 3. Understand the role of France in the context, the challenges and opportunities in it.
Subject Synopsis/ Indicative Syllabus	1. <u>Paris Fashion: Culture and Style</u> The origins of haute couture beginning with Charles Frederick Worth and extending through the end of World War I, the collections of the Musee de la Mode to explore the quality demands of couture; the art of haute couture: from Chanel to La Croix, construction techniques and marketing techniques. Site visits to the salons of such as Dior, Yves St. Laurant, and the like. 2. <u>French Retail: Past, Present and Future</u> The origins of the French retail systems from Les Passages to Les Grands Magasins, and how the notion of the department store developed in Paris and influenced the world; Pret-a-porter and the rise of the Department Store. Seminars include executives from the

	three leading stores, Le Printemps, Galleries Lafayette and Samaritaine on the future of French retailing. 3. <u>Consumer Motivation, European Style</u> Demographics and psychographics of the Continental European consumer, and comparisons with the American, European and Asian populace. 4. <u>Luxury Branding as a Marketing Force</u> Strategies that company has taken to remain the premier luxury goods disseminator in the world. Visit to the LVMH headquarter; seminars on Hermes by Bernard Arnault and on Faconnable by Serge Philip, director of merchandising and Walter Breuer, owner of Faconnable. 5. <u>Production Specialties: Made in France</u> Successful French niche-goods marketing, from perfume to pate, the French talent for elevating a national identity through product and its marketing. Site visits to Quest International and Fauchon. A trip to Reims sponsored by LVMH, the ultimate French niche market: champagne, all aspects of production, marketing and exportation.
Teaching/Learning Methodology	During the course of the program, the students from ITC of The Hong Kong Polytechnic University, as well as those master students from Institute Francais de la Mode (IFM in Paris) and the Fashion Institute of Technology (FIT in New York) will convene for two weeks at each of the participating institutions for an intensive seminar and site visits. The purpose is to explore aspects of the fashion industry particular to that city and that region of the world. Topics to be covered include fashion influences and trend spotting, consumer behavior, major retailers and their strategies for success, and production capabilities. Each participating institution brings a unique perspective to the program. These include manufacturing, merchandising, and global supply management from ITC, marketing of luxury goods with cultural tradition and newest expression from IFM, and product development and wholesaling and retailing from FIT. While in Paris, students will participate in class seminars, site visits and meetings with industry leaders. Cultural excursions will be arranged for the students to encourage further interchange among the students.

Assessment Methods in Alignment with Intended Learning Outcomes	Specific assessment methods/tasks	% weighting	Intended subject learning outcomes to be assessed		
			1	2	3
	1. Coursework	100%	✓	✓	✓
	Total	100%			
	Case study can bring about a deep understanding of the market in the region, further the interaction with students of different cultures can enhance the leadership, organization and communication skill. Written assignment is designed for a reflection in an applied and theoretical manner.				
Student Study Effort Expected	Class contact: (all in 2 weeks)				
	▪ Seminars			39 Hrs.	
	Other student study effort:				
	▪ Assignment			20 Hrs.	
	▪ Reading			46 Hrs.	
	Total student study effort			105 Hrs.	
Reading List and References	<u>Indicative Reading List and References:</u>				
	1. Bartlett, Christopher A. and Sumantra Ghoshal. Managing Across Borders: The Transnational Solution. Harvard Business School Press, 2002.				
	2. Hollenbeck, George P. and Morgan W. McCall, Jr. Developing Global Executives: The Lessons of International Experience. Harvard Business School Press, 2001.				
	3. Eicher, Joanne B., Lutz, Hazel and Evenson, Sandra Lee. Visible Self: Global Perspectives on Dress. Culture, and Society Fairchild Books, February 2000. ISBN: 1563670682.				
	4. Fox, Robert and Turner, Anthony John. Luxury Trades and Consumerism in Ancient Regime Paris: Studies in the History of the Skilled Workforce. Ashgate Publishing, Ltd., June 1998. ISBN: 0860786641.				
	5. Gronow, Jukka. Sociology of Taste. Routledge, June 1997. ISBN: 0415132959.				
	6. Higgitt, John. The Murthly Hours: Devotion, Literacy and Luxury in Paris. England and the Gaelic West (British Library Studies in Medieval Culture). University of Toronto Press, January 2001. ISBN: 0802047599.				

	7. Purdy, Daniel. The Tyranny of Elegance: Consumer Cosmopolitanism in the Era of Goethe Johns Hopkins University Press, October 1998. ISBN: 0801858747. 8. Sargentson, Carolyn. Merchants and Luxury Markets: The Marchands Merciers of Eighteenth-Century Paris. Getty Publications, April 1996. ISBN: 0892362952. 9. Twitchell, James B. Living It Up: Our Love Affair with Luxury Columbia University Press, December 2001. ISBN: 0231124961.
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